

LEARN FABULOUS FAIR ISLES



by
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Fabulous Fair Isles



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History

Fair Isle handknits originated from the Scottish island of the same name. They are characterized by their geometric motifs inspired by patterns in nature and, crucially, by the sequence of foreground and background colour changes. These two aspects are easily translated into machine knits.



A vintage Fair Isle handknit

THE BRITISH ISLES: PHYSICAL.



How to

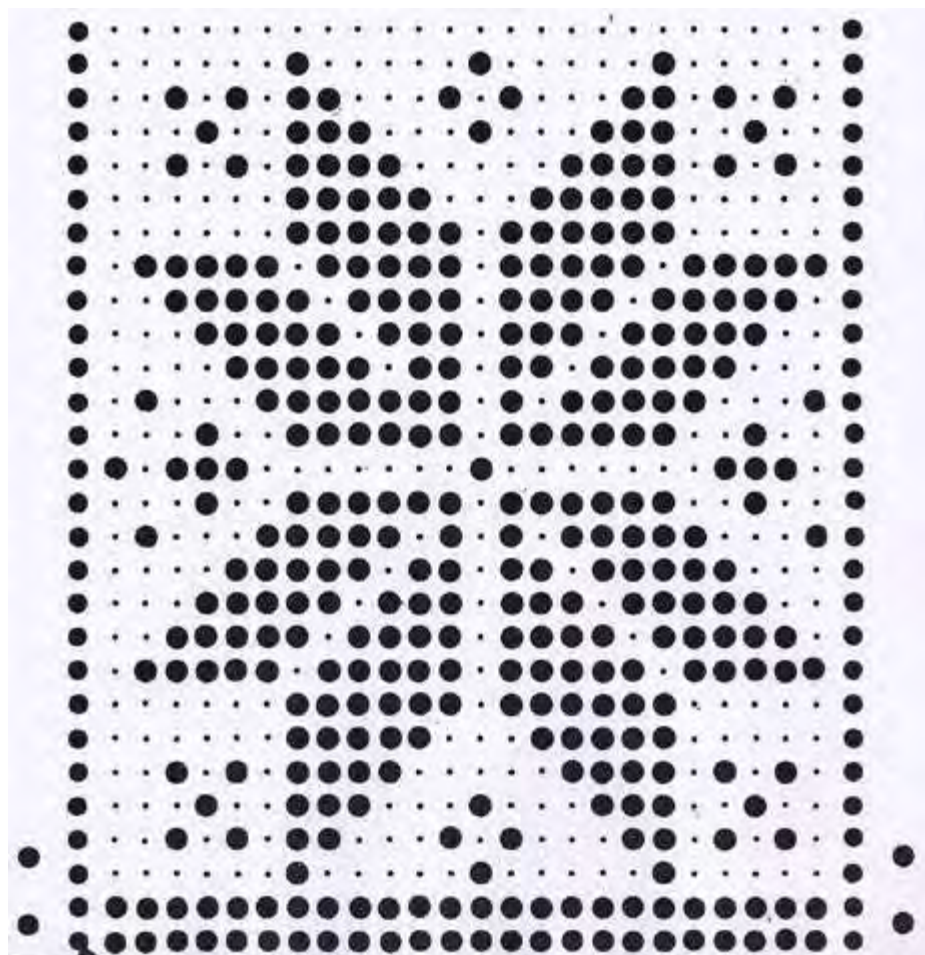
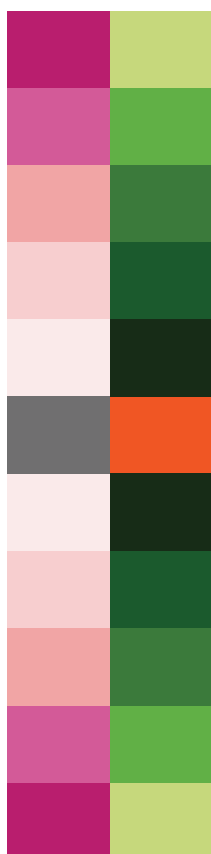
*To make Fair Isles on the Brother knitting machine the settings are '**KC**' to move the needles into position and '**MC**' to knit 2 colours at a time. On a Knitmaster/Silver Reed machine the setting is '**F**'.*

The background colour is in feeder A and knits the unpunched parts of a card. The foreground colour is in feeder B and knits the punched areas of a card.



FEEDER

A **B**



Colour changes

The following examples show how a simple punchcard can be adapted to several colourways.

1. Pink background (feeder A) / Green foreground (feeder B), Starting with the darkest shade of pink and lightest shade of green
2. Pink Background (feeder A) / Green foreground (feeder B), Starting with the lightest shade of pink and darkest shade of green
3. Green background (feeder A) / Pink foreground (feeder B), Starting with the darkest shade of green and lightest shade of pink
4. Green background (feeder A) / pink foreground (feeder B), Starting with the lightest shade of green and darkest shade of pink



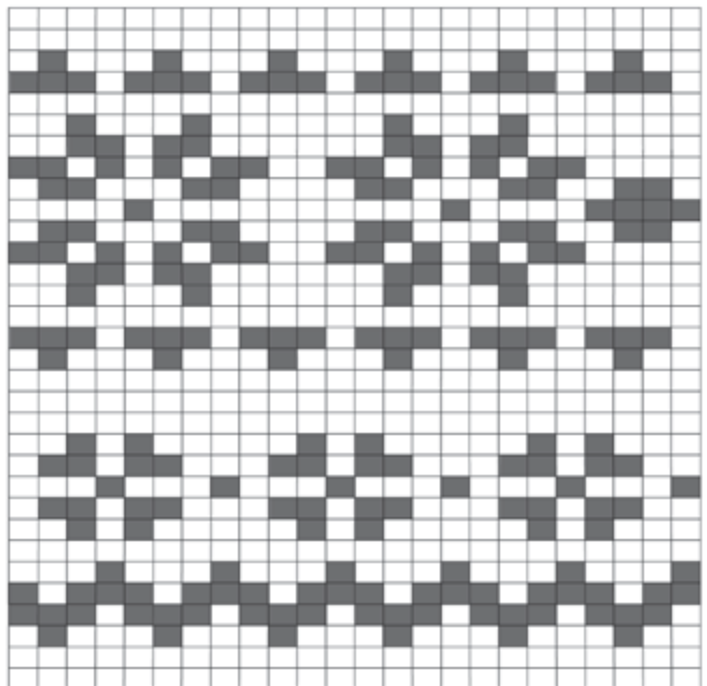


One punchcard, five variations



The glory of traditional Fair Isles is the wonderful diversity of colours and patterns. Using your knitting machine it is very easy to get myriad variations using one punchcard!

To illustrate this we have punched a simple pattern and combined colours and repeats in five different ways to explore the possible variations.



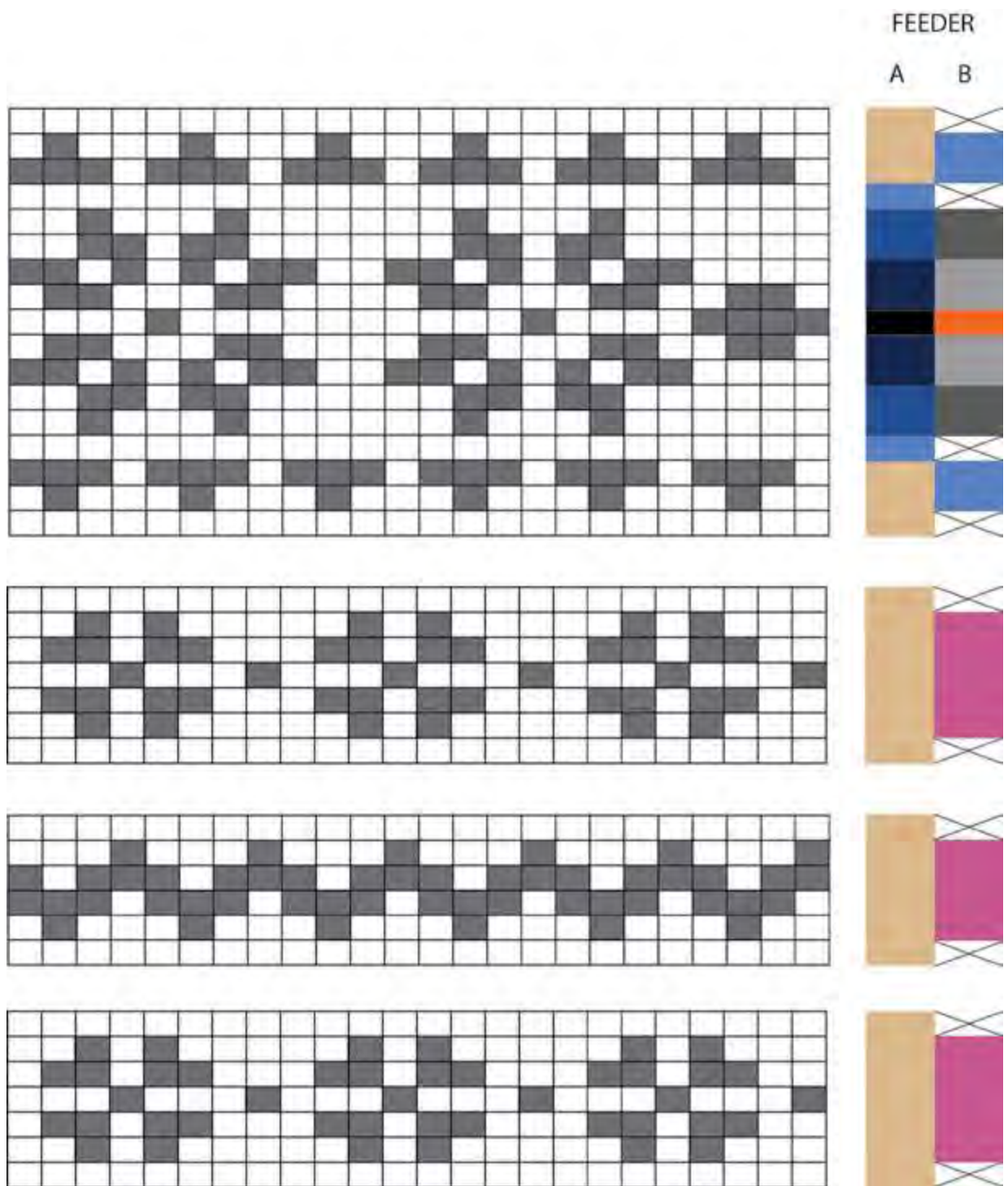


Oatmeal scarf

- Finished dimensions 38cm x 152cm
- Width 120sts
- Knit 20r to start
- Repeat motif 12 times
- Knit 20r to finish







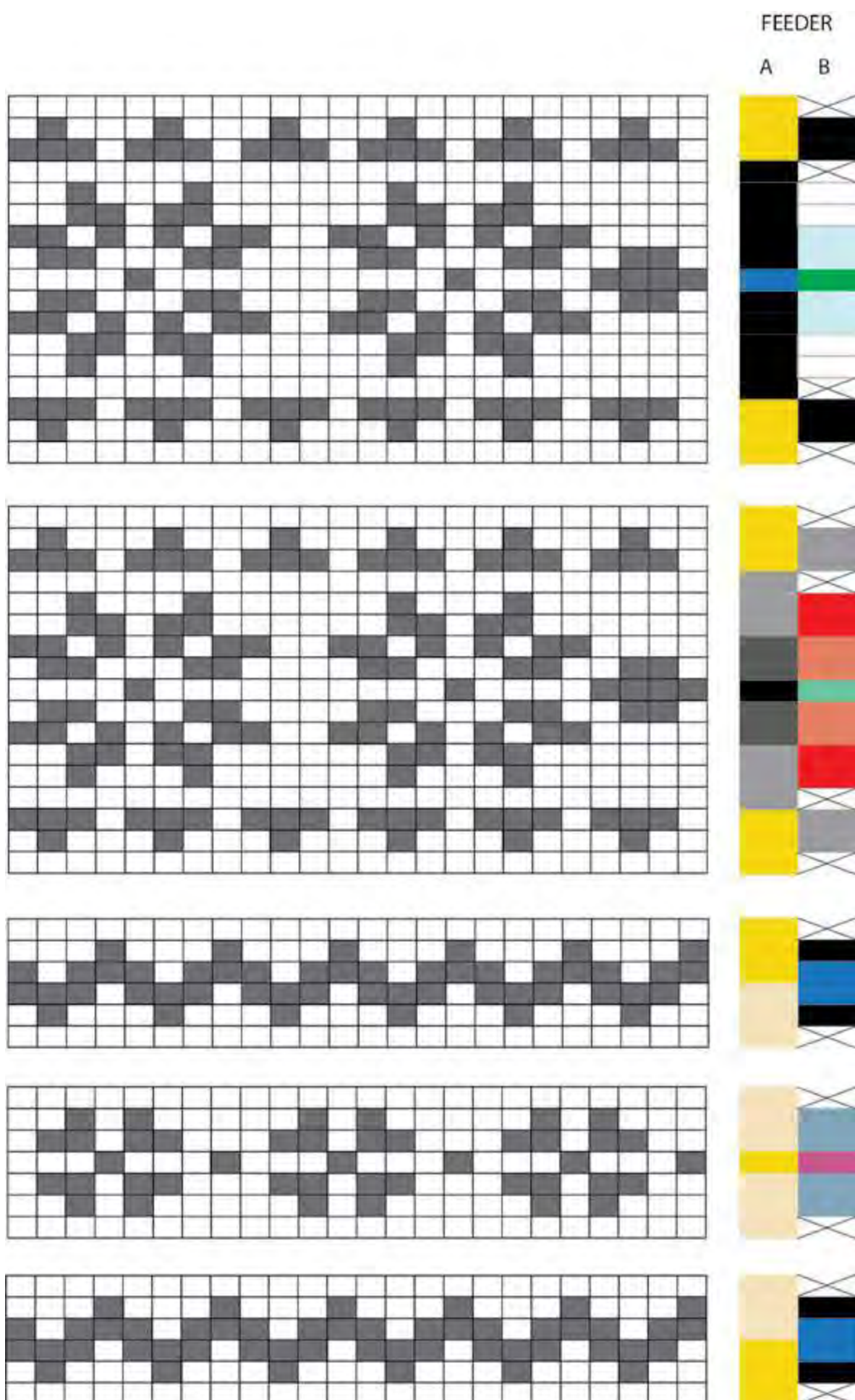


Yellow scarf

- Finished dimensions 38cm x 160cm
- Width 120sts
- Knit 20r to start
- Knit motif and mirror the next repeat
- Knit repeat 8 times mirroring the motif all along
- Knit 20r to finish









Navy scarf

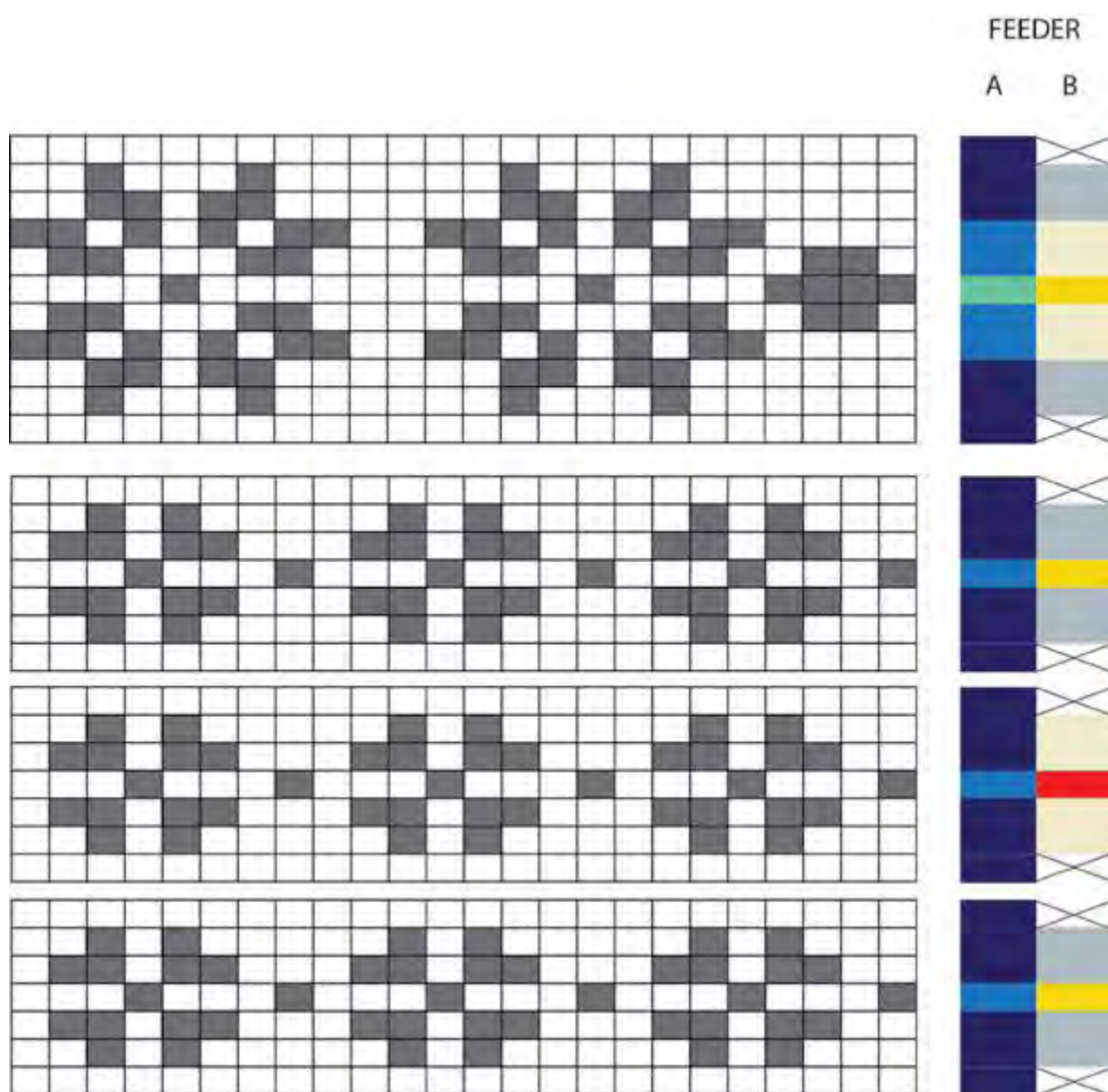
- Finished dimensions 38cm x 164cm
- Width 120sts
- Knit 40r to start
- Knit motif and add stripe detail.

Knit repeat 3 times and finish with the punchcard motif (without stripe detail).

- Knit 40r to finish







To create the full repeat start by knitting this, mirror it and add stripe detail.

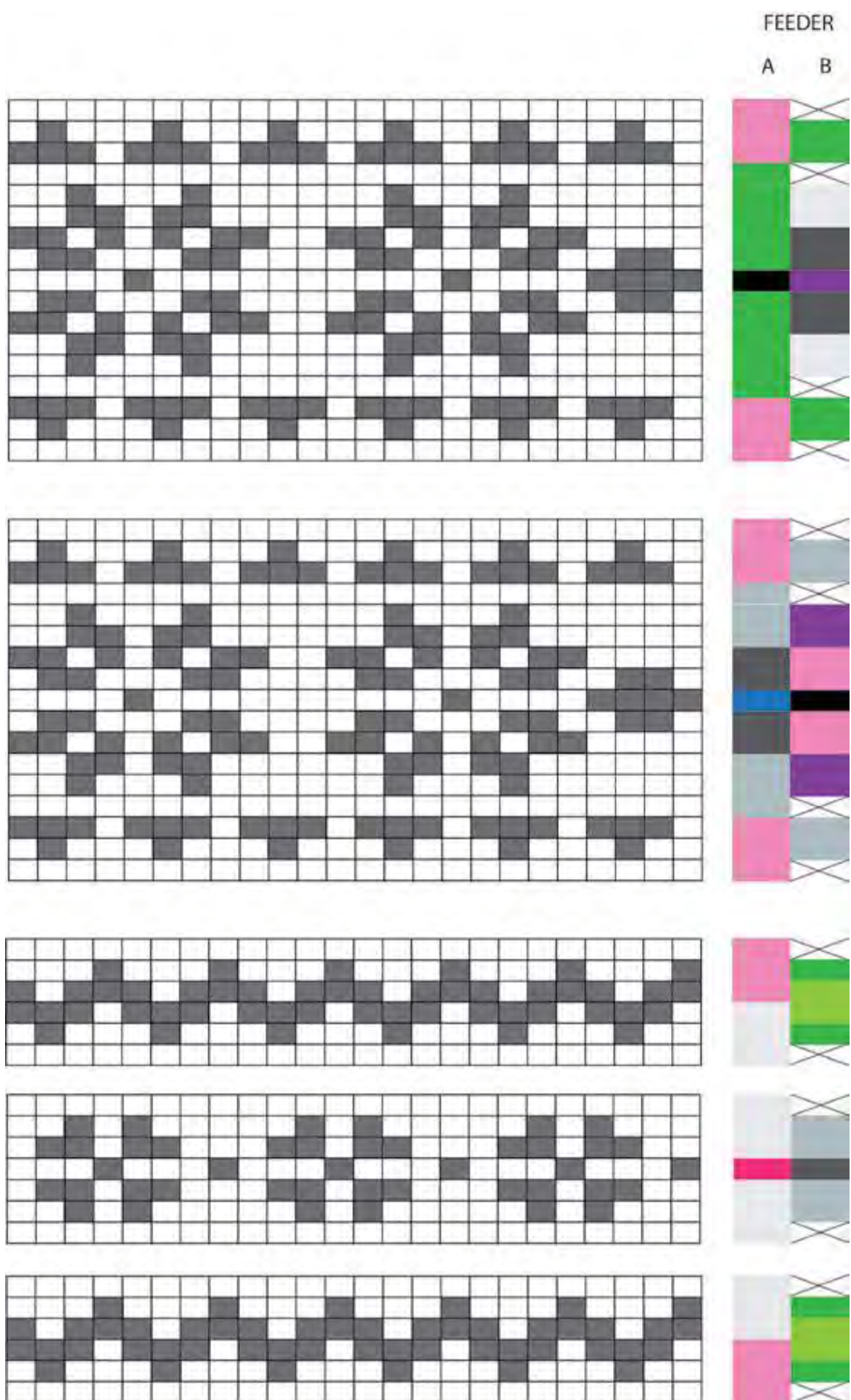


Pink scarf

- Finished dimensions 38cm x 181cm
- Width 120sts
- Knit 25r to start
- Knit motif and mirror the next repeat
- Knit repeat 8 times mirroring the motif all along
- Knit 25r to finish









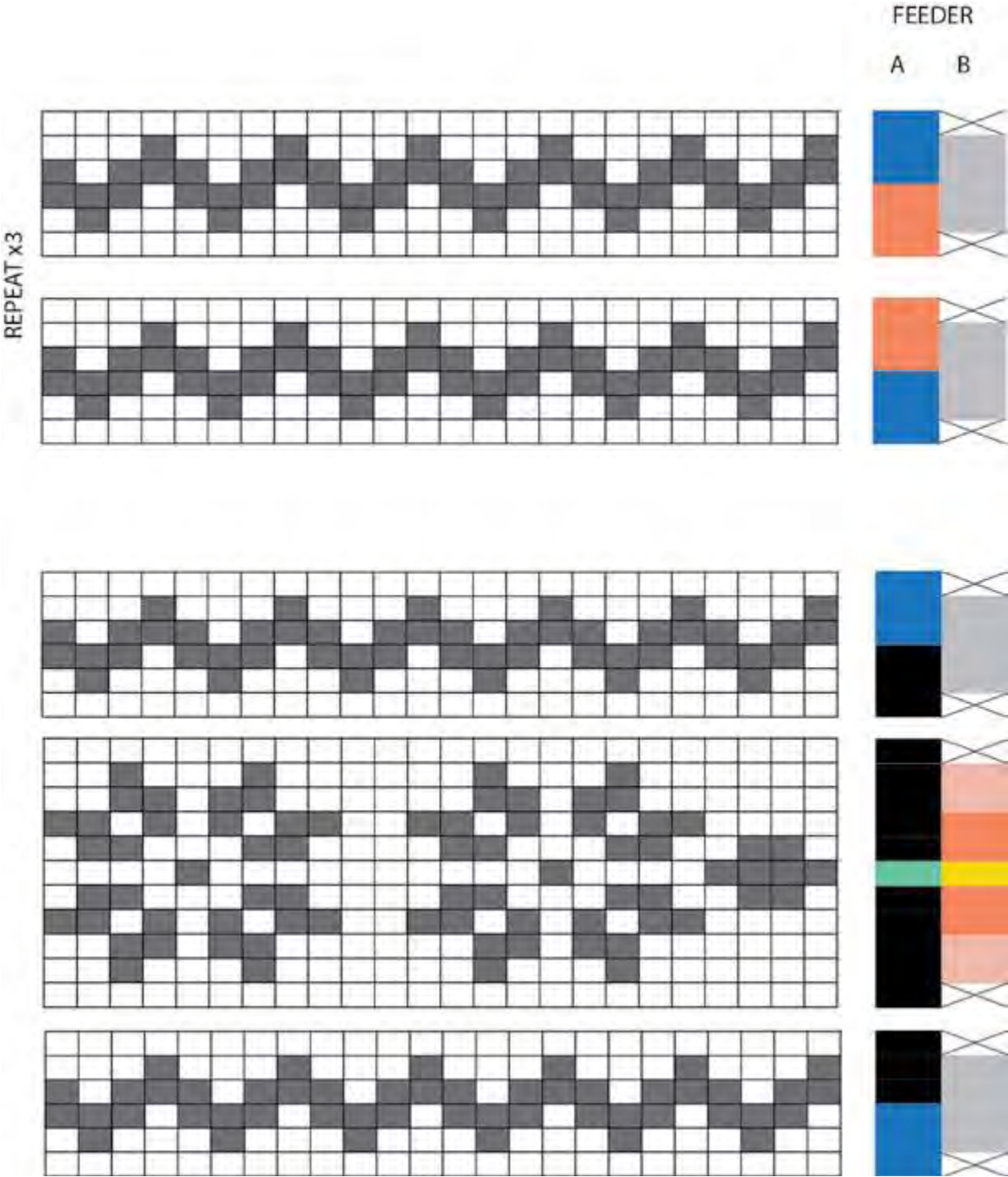
Blue scarf

- Finished dimensions 38cm x 166cm
- Width 120sts
- Knit 40r to start
- Repeat motif 3 times with red, yellow&black and peach&grey zig zag striping
- knit the flower motif in the centre
- knit repeat 3 times mirroring the first half
- Knit 40r to finish

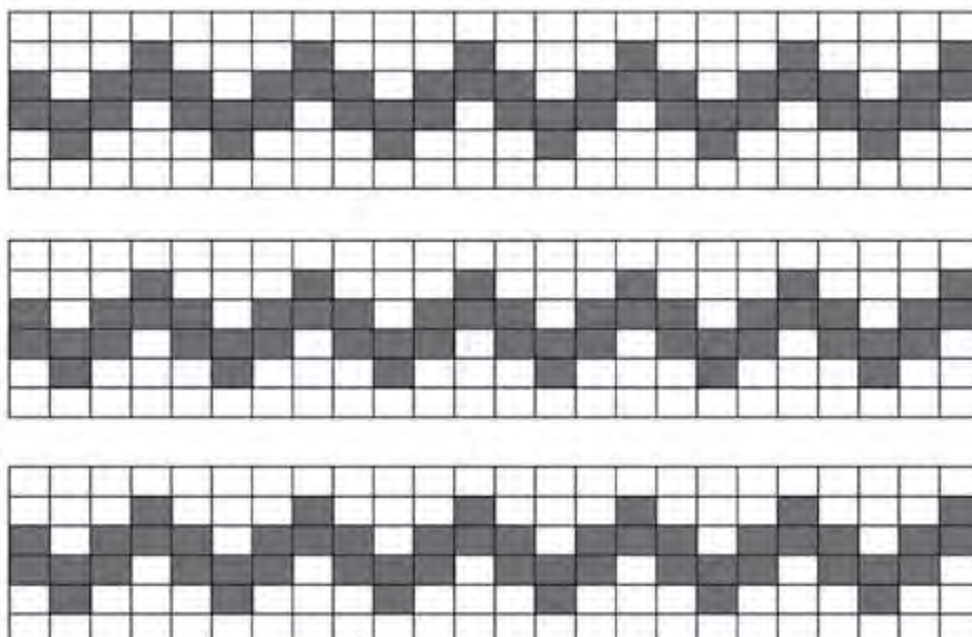




Knit this for the first repeat. For the second repeat change colours for the zig zag stripes to yellow, black and grey. For the third repeat change colours for the zigzag stripes to peach, grey and black.



2nd REPEAT mirror back to blue

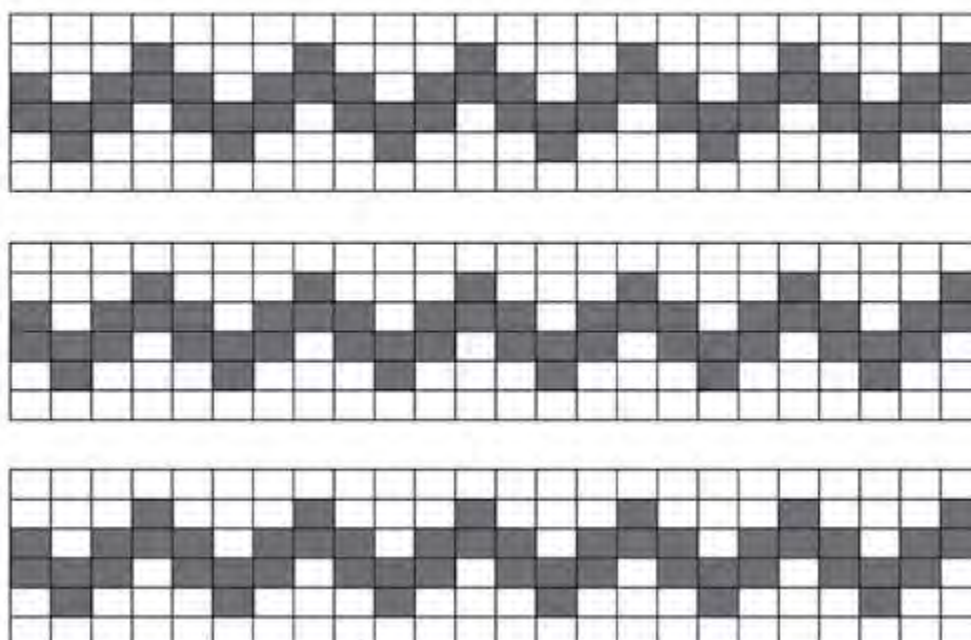


FEEDER

A B



3rd REPEAT mirror back to blue



FEEDER

A B



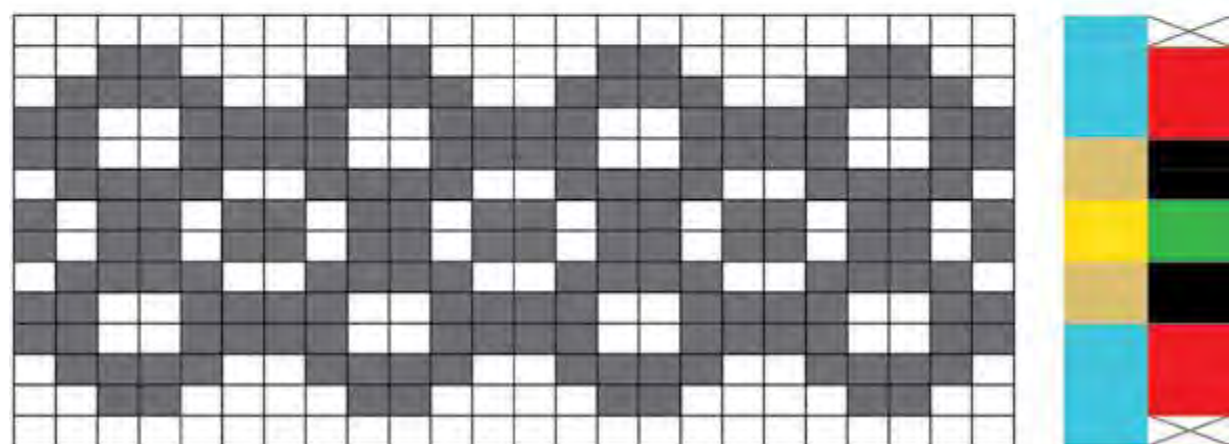
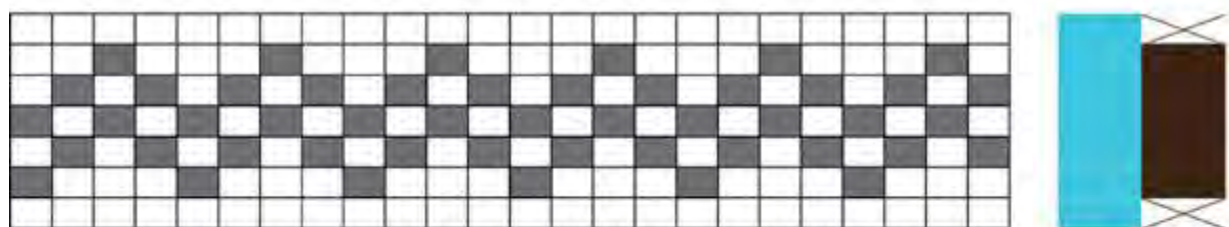
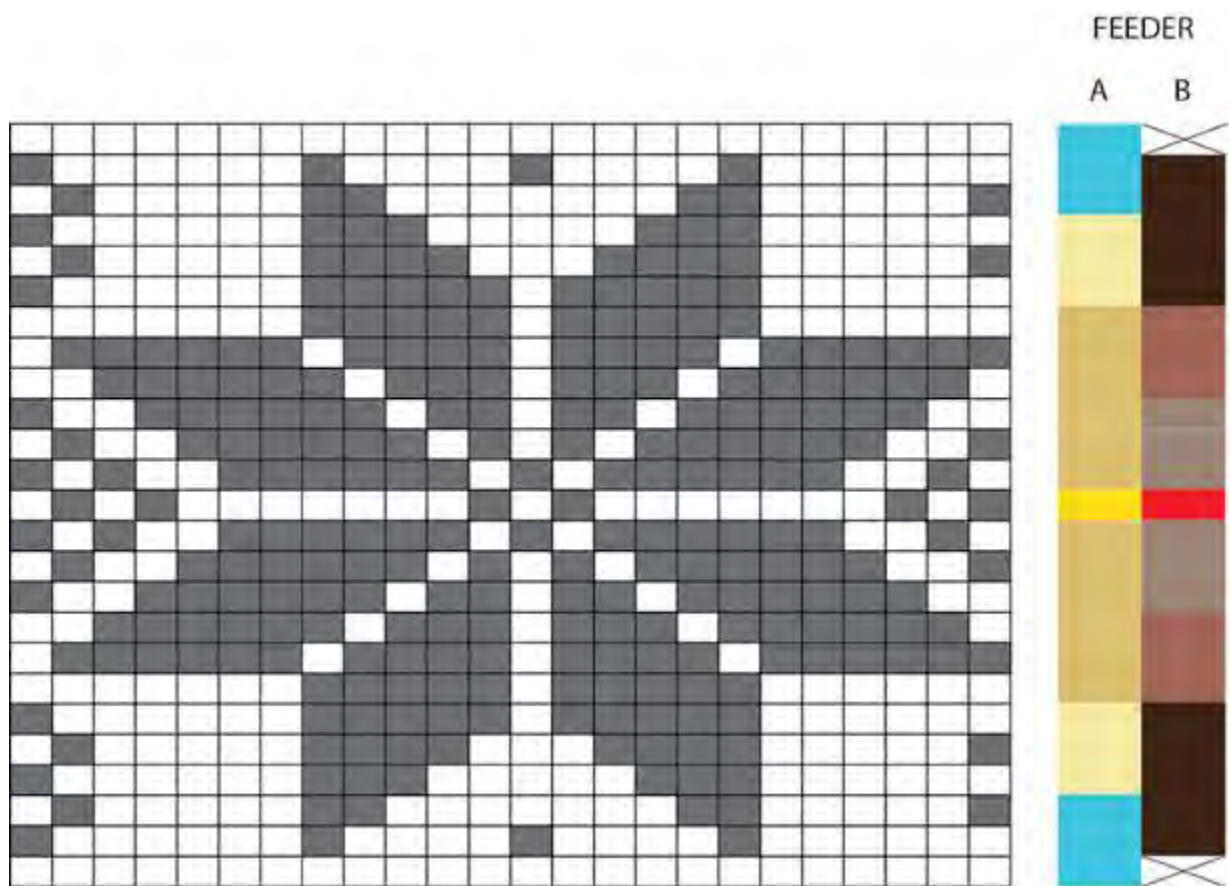




Mens Fair Isle sweater

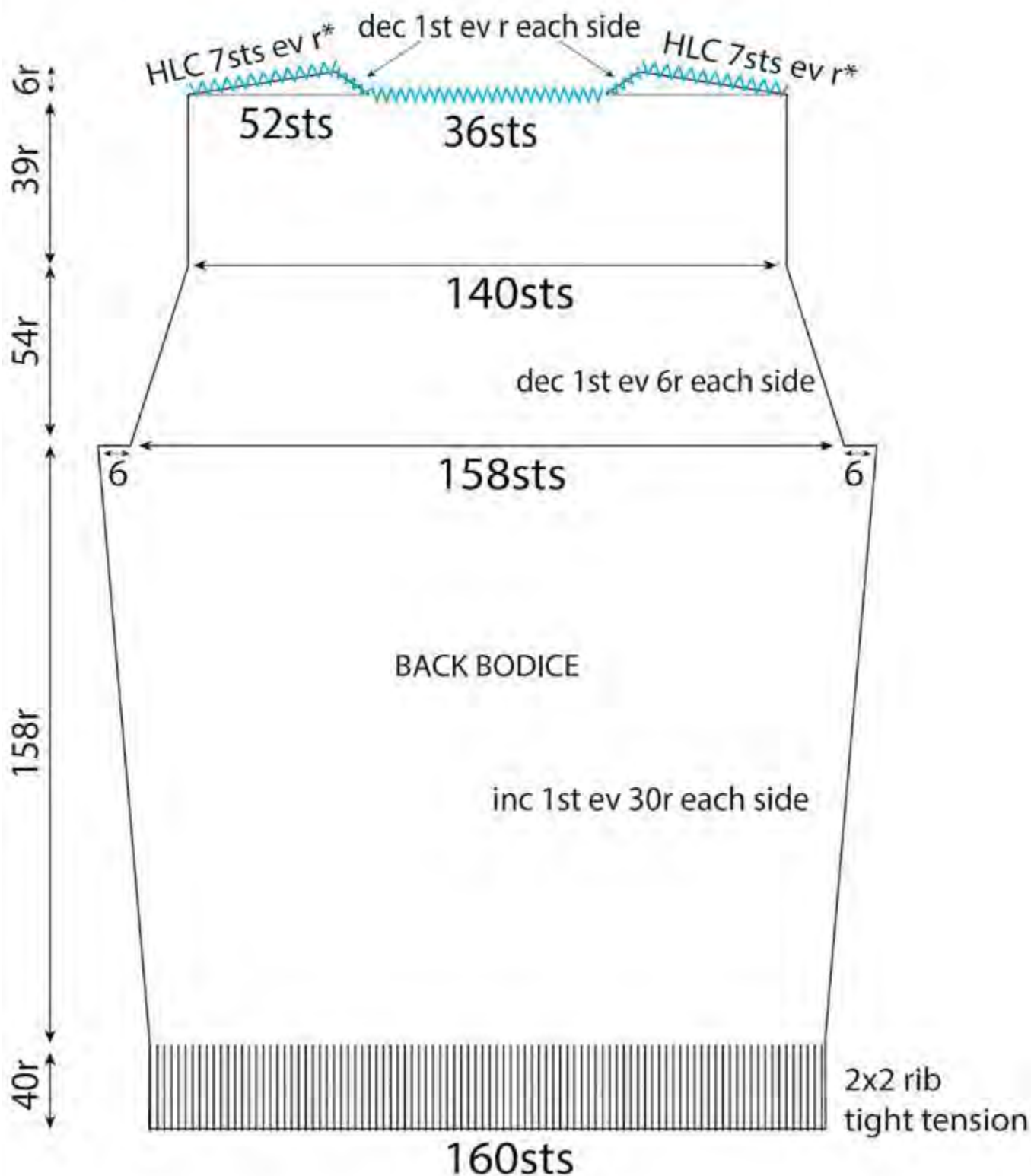
We knitted the Mens Fair Isle sweater with 3 ends of 2/36 cashmere/merino wool with tension 8.2 on a standard 5gg Brother machine. To achieve the correct size match the tension on your machine to 10cm : 37r, 10cm : 32sts (to fit 38"/40" chest).



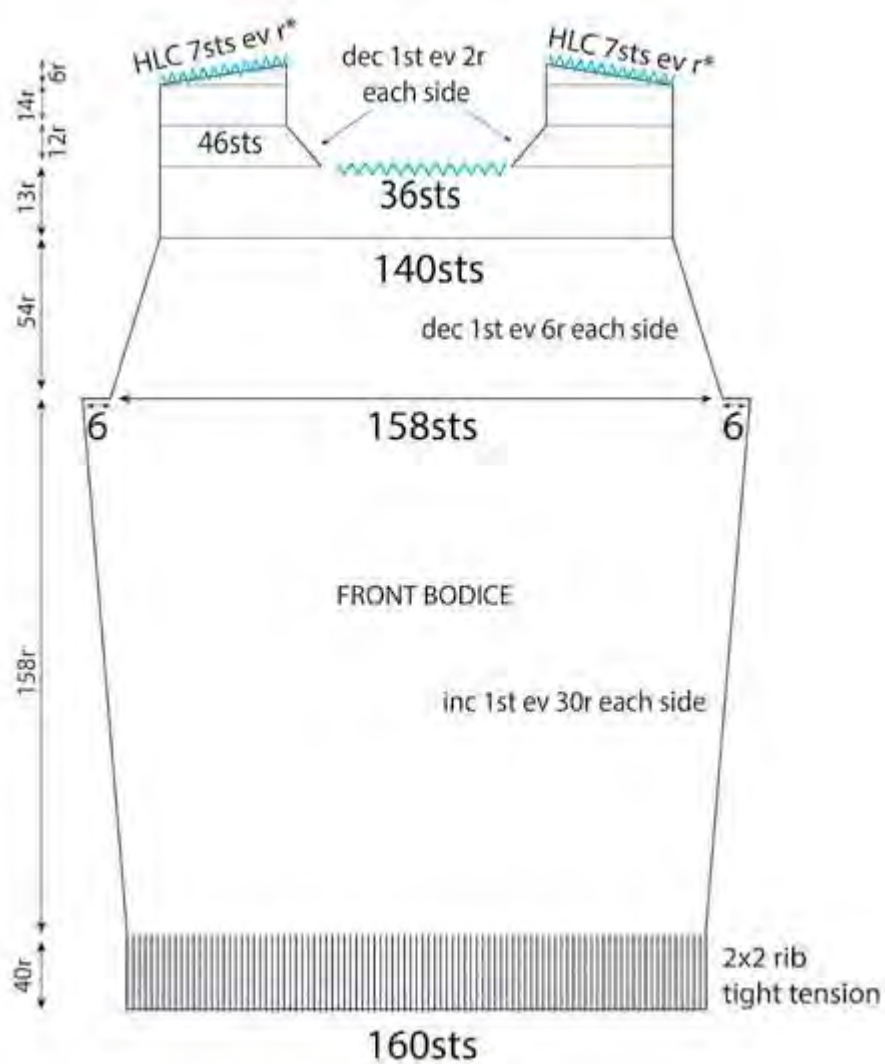


Mens Fair Isle sweater pattern

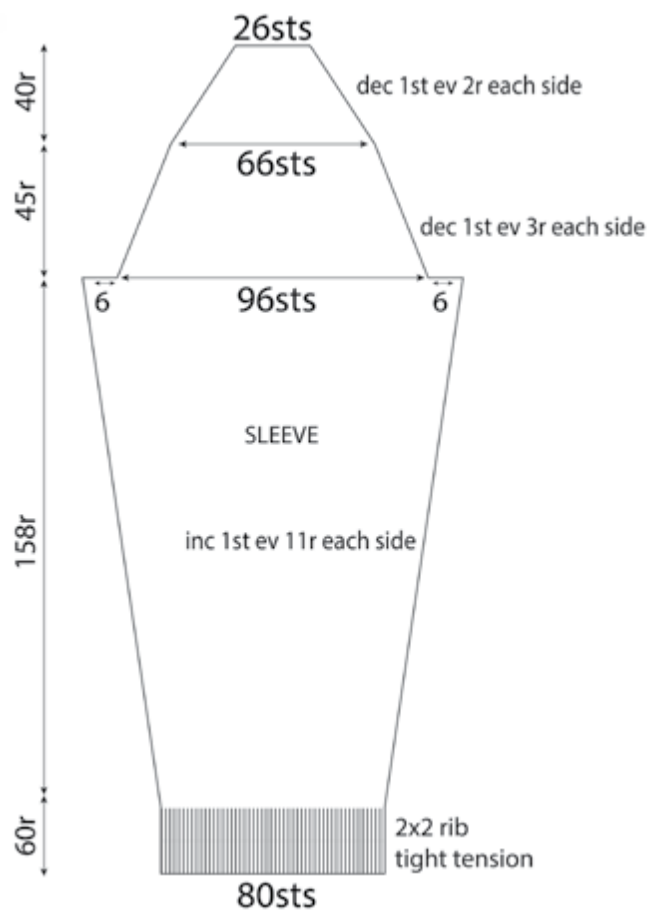
Neckline 2x2 rib, 160sts x 14r. Knit with tight tension.



*7x6=42sts + 4sts remaining unfashioned



*7x6=42sts + 4sts remaining unfashioned

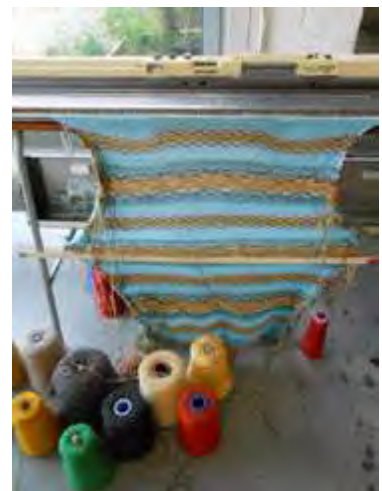
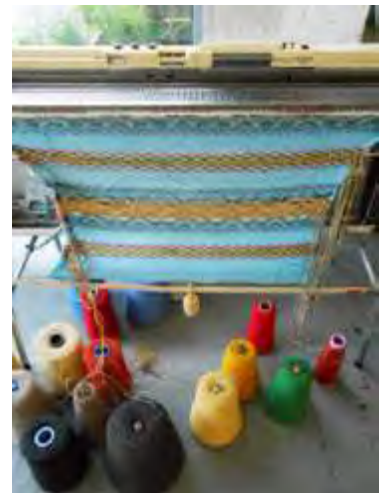


Mens Fair Isle sweater

Start by knitting the back bodice.

Make a 2x2 rib with tight tension and hang it on to a single bed. Follow the shaping and the fair isle punchcard and colour changes.

Use holding cams to create the shaping on the neckline and shoulders and take off on waste yarn.





Knit the front bodice. Take the neckline and left shoulder off on waste yarn and knit the right shoulder strap. Use holding cams to create shaping on the shoulder and take off on waste yarn. Repeat on the left shoulder strap but leave it on the machine. Hang the back bodice shoulder against the front, knit together with a loose row and cast off with the latch hook.



Mens Fair Isle sweater



Hang the front and the back on the machine along the neckline with the plain side facing you. Attach the neckline rib. Hang the rib stitch by stitch against the bodice (right sides against each other). Knit all the stitches together with a hand knitted loose row. Cast off with a latch hook.



Hang both the front and back on the machine on the left shoulder. Knit together with a loose row and cast off with a loose row.



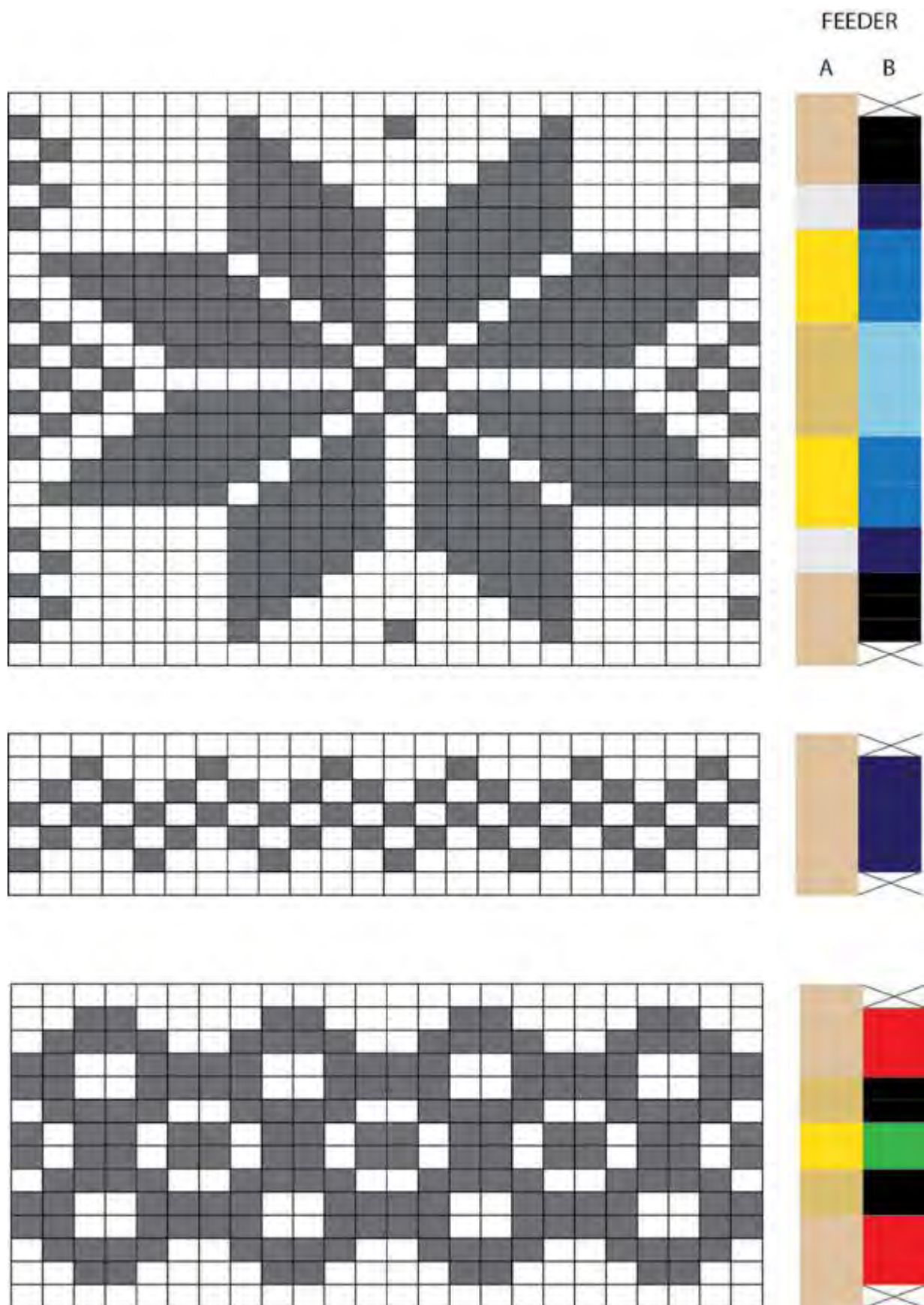
Knit the sleeves.

To assemble the sweater first sew the sleeve head along the armhole shaping on the bodice. Finish by sewing the side seams together all along from the cuff through underarm to side seam and hem.



You can use the same punchcard with your own colour combinations to make unique Fair Isle designs.

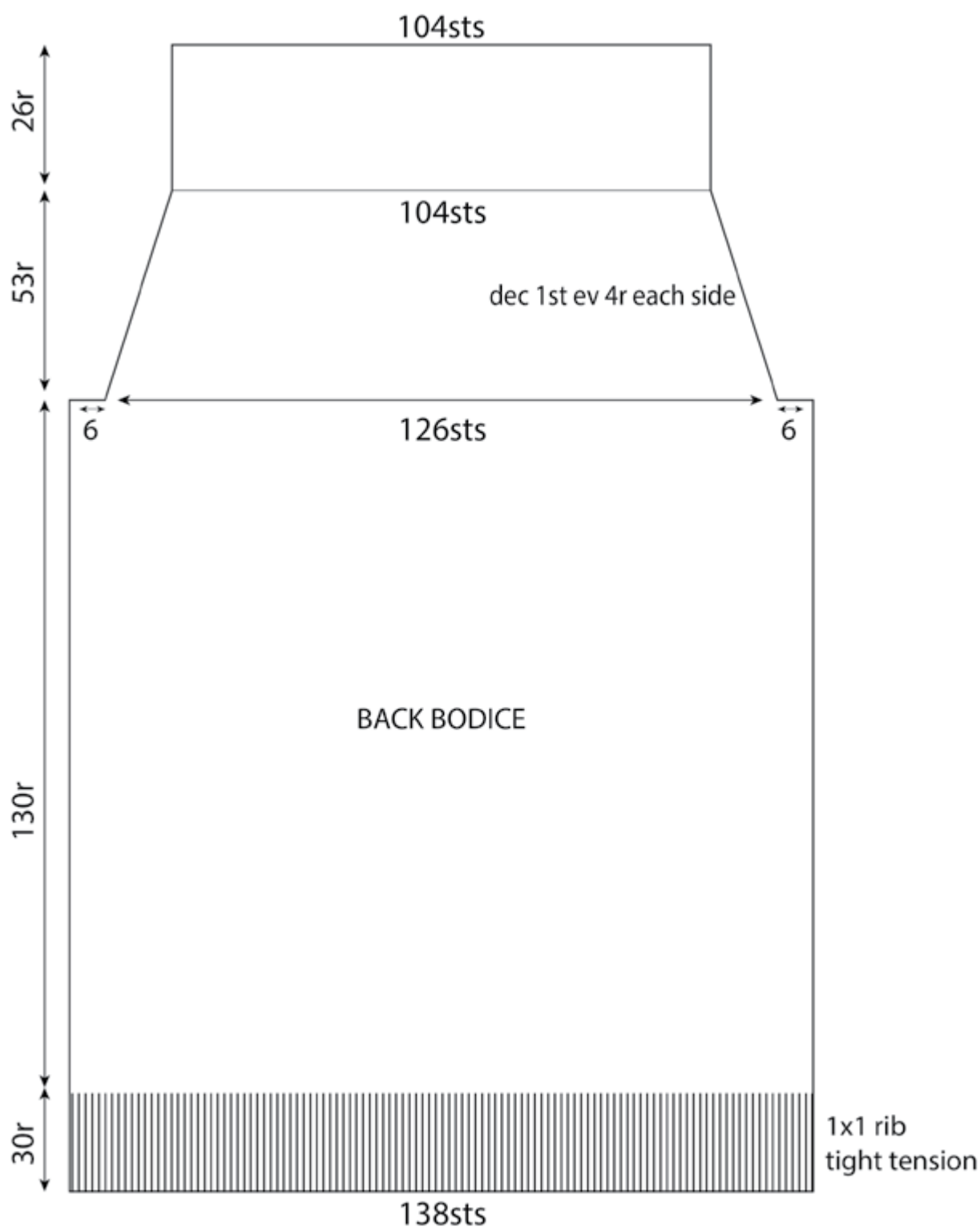
Womens v-neck cardigan

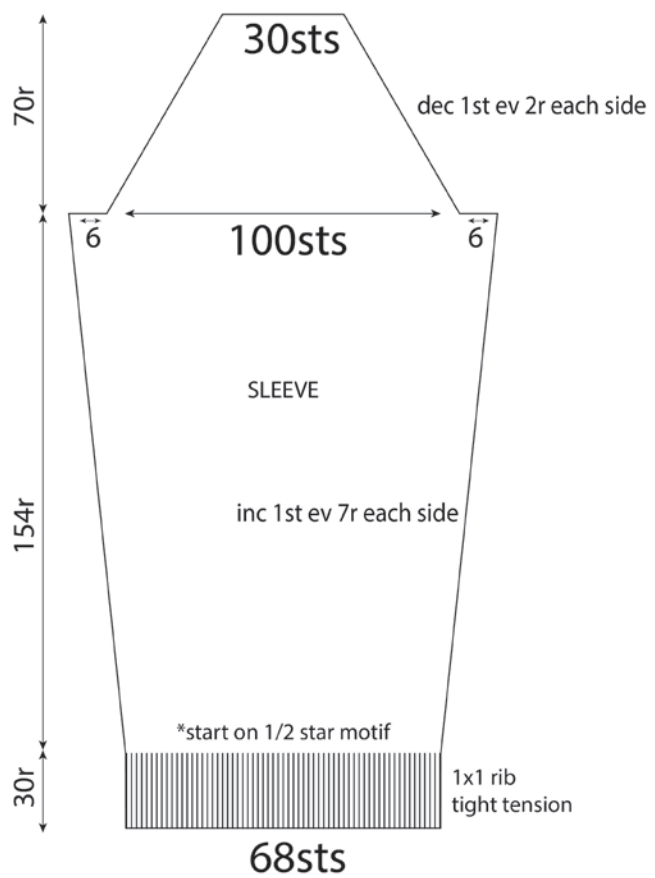
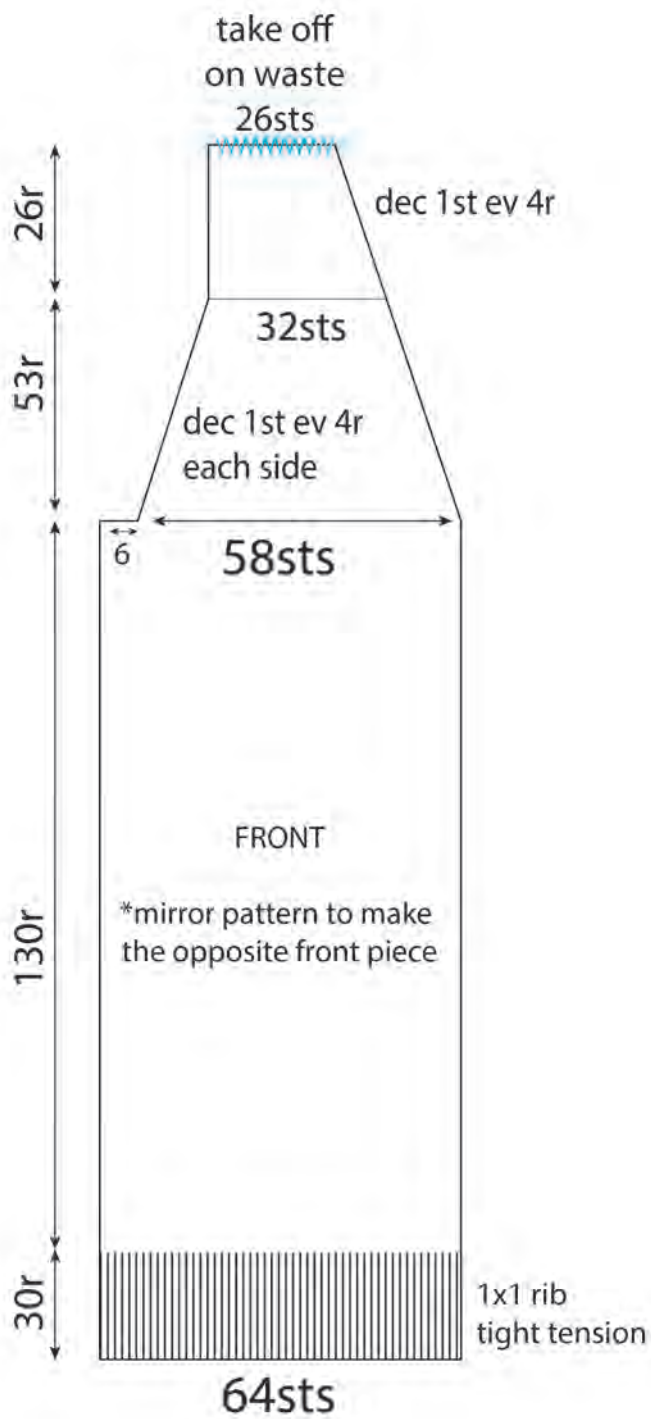




Womens v-neck cardigan

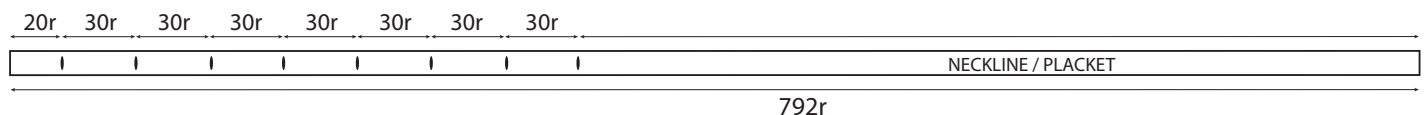
We have knitted the Womens v-neck cardigan with 2 ends of 2/15 lambswool with tehnsion 8.2 on a standard 5gg Brother machine. To achieve the size 34"/36" bust match the tension 10cm : 42r, 10cm : 33sts on your machine.





$\frac{11}{12}$ Placket width, all needle layout
 $\frac{4}{5}$ Button hole

Neckline knitted on double bed /
ribber machine, double jersey
Tension; 3sts:1cm, 6r:1cm





Useful Information

cast off	bind off
e-wrap	Cast on method for finished edge. Loop yarn around needles from left to right making the shape of a lower case e around each needle while needles are in E position
needle positions	A non working position / needles will not knit B working position / needles will knit D <i>BROTHER</i> C <i>KNITMASTER</i> selected for pattern knitting/intarsia needles will knit E <i>BROTHER</i> D <i>KNITMASTER</i> holding position / needles will knit unless holding cam is switched to H or II position
r	rows (abbreviation)
sts	stitches (abbreviation)
swatch	piece of knitting / fabric

Our Profile



Richard Dykes and Sue Enticknap have created and sold fashion since 1983 becoming established as one of the top fashion textile design companies, designing and selling to the industry at all levels of the market.

For over 3 decades we have designed and made our copyrighted one-off creative designs. We have an extensive range of customers and hence we are constantly working with the fashion industry worldwide.

As directors of Knit-1 Ltd we are dedicated to supplying our customers with ever changing, beautiful and original fashion textiles incorporating the best quality of design, make and finish.

It is this degree of professional expertise that has enabled the company to uniquely offer a wide range of intensive machine knit, embroidery and print courses taken at our premises as design workshops, also offering downloads and books available online and in selected bookstores. See our dedicated website (www.knitdesigncourses.com).

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